CALIFORNIA PUBLIC RECORDS ACT

Public Records Request

TO — AGENCY / OFFICE: _____

ATTN: _____ **DATE:** _____

AGENCY ADDRESS: _____

AGENCY EMAIL (IF SENDING BY EMAIL): _____

RE: California Public Records Act Request — _____

To the Custodian of Records:

Pursuant to the California Public Records Act, Government Code section 7920.000 et seq., I request copies of the following records:

SUBJECT / PERSON / MATTER: _____ **CASE / FILE NO.:** _____

DATE RANGE: from _____ to _____ **LOCATION (IF ANY):** _____

1. Records requested: _____
2. _____
3. For each record, include where available: date and time, record / incident number, type, location, responding unit(s), and disposition.

As to arrest records, Government Code section 7923.600 provides that the name, time and date of arrest, location, and charges are public, subject to the redactions the statute allows. Please produce any associated report with exempt material redacted, rather than withholding it in full.

If a search as written would be unduly burdensome, please identify the incident number(s), or the date and location of any responsive contact or record, and I will narrow the request accordingly.

I request copies in electronic form (Government Code section 7922.500). Please notify me within ten days whether responsive records exist and the estimated time to produce them (Government Code section 7922.535), and identify any record withheld along with the legal basis for withholding it (Government Code section 7922.600). Please notify me of any estimated duplication cost before incurring it.

REQUESTER NAME: _____

MAILING ADDRESS: _____

EMAIL / PHONE: _____

SIGNATURE: _____ **DATE:** _____

INSTRUCTION SHEET — DO NOT SEND THIS PAGE

How to Fill In the Template

Sheet 1 is the request to send. This sheet explains it. For member use in the free law library, for drafting purposes. No personal information appears in either sheet — every specific is yours to fill in.

Fill in each underlined line on Sheet 1

Agency / Office	The full name of the agency or department that holds the records.
Attn	Records Unit or Custodian of Records — or the specific office, if you know it.
Agency Address	That agency's published mailing address, copied exactly as the agency lists it.
Agency Email	That agency's records email address, if you are sending by email.
Date (top)	The date you send the request.
Re	A short description of the records, in a few words.
Subject / Person / Matter	The full name of the person, or the matter or event, the records concern.
Case / File No.	A case, incident, citation, or file number if you know one; leave blank if you do not.
Date Range	The start and end dates the records cover — see the date-window note below.
Location	The place of the contact or event, if any.
Records Requested	The record types, named plainly: e.g., dispatch / CAD entries, call logs, incident or arrest reports, citations, booking records, dispatch audio, or emails. Use the second line for more, or for locating details.
Requester Name	Your full name.
Mailing Address	Your mailing address — where the agency can send its reply and copies.
Email / Phone	Your email address and phone number, so the agency can reach you with questions.
Signature & Date	Sign the printed copy and date it. If sending by email, type your full name in place of a signature.

Keep the date window tight

- Use the narrowest range that covers the contact or event — **60 to 90 days** is usually enough.
- Do not use a multi-year sweep. A five-year name search invites the agency to refuse the request as burdensome.
- If the agency calls the search burdensome, the letter already offers to narrow it: ask the agency to identify the incident number, or the date and location of the contact, then resend a narrower request.

Sending the request

- **Print:** print Sheet 1 only, fill it in, sign it, keep a copy, and mail it. Keep the mailing receipt.
- **Email:** paste the text of Sheet 1 into the body of an email, fill in each line in the email itself, and use the Re line as the subject line. Save the sent email.
- **Send to both agencies when the agency is unclear:** if you do not know which agency made the contact, send a copy to each agency that may hold the records — for example, both a city police department and a county sheriff's office. The contacting or arresting agency is often not obvious from a log alone.
- If the contact was a traffic stop, a citation number can be the fastest route; citation numbers also route through the court clerk.

After you send it

[ ] Write down the date sent and the method (mail or email) on your copy.

[ ] The agency's determination is due within 10 days (Gov. Code section 7922.535).

[ ] **Save every reply with its envelope and date** — for email, save the full message with its headers and the date received.

[ ] Note any record withheld and the legal basis the agency gave for withholding it.

[ ] File the copies you receive with the date, the agency, and the request they came from.